ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

'Sometimes we have to do a thing in order to find out the reason for it. Sometimes our actions are questions, not answers' [John le Carré, *The Perfect Spy*]. Taking up an unfunded doctoral position in London on a topic requiring expensive (and sometimes scary) fieldwork, especially after quitting a journalism job in India, is insane. Working on this book explained to me why I did so. Finding answers to bothersome questions needed time and effort that academia afforded best. Though the idea of this book emerged during my stints of (f)unemployment and chasing stories as a young journalist, it flourished as a doctoral dissertation at King's College London under Harsh Pant's stellar supervision. A master of the trade, Harsh entertained my (various) ideas with patience and helped develop the reasonable ones into what you see here.

Christophe Jaffrelot and Chris Ogden's encouragement and constructive feedback as examiners helped sharpen my arguments, whereas Srinath Raghavan's interventions at key moments offered breakthroughs. In their own ways Tracey German, Wyn Bowen, Sunil Khilnani, Theo Farrell, and Rudra Chaudhuri taught me a lot about academia and writing, whereas Geraint Hughes allowed me to steal the title of his book for my own. Lynda Hobbs, Lyn Reynolds, Lucy Fisher, and Karen Crouch at the Defence Studies Department made this journey an administrative breeze.

Giving it financial legs, the King's Continuation Scholarship, the Defence Studies Research Studentship, and various small grants offered by the King's Graduate School ensured sustainability and progress of this project. The UK-